



Will projecting Narendra Modi as its prime ministerial candidate in the next general elections help the BJP's poll prospects?

Help to a great extent	19
Help to some extent	24
No impact	25
Harm to some extent	6
Harm to a great extent	3

Don't know/can't say: 23 (All figures in per cent)

Which party is capable of providing a stable coalition government?

BJP	BSP	Cong	CPI(M)
27	4	34	4

Other Parties: 27; Don't know/can't say: 4 (All figures in per cent)

How would you rate Rahul Gandhi as a politician?

Poor	Average	Good	Outstanding
5	33	43	8

Don't know/can't say: 11 (All figures in per cent)



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polls, taken a full four years after he left office and virtually went out of sight, Vajpayee stood head and shoulders above his rivals, including Sonia Gandhi and Manmohan. For the first time ever, Manmohan with 18 per cent votes scored over Sonia (15) while the former prime minister shares the third place with the BJP's prime minister-in-waiting L.K. Advani (12 per cent). Two out of every three Indians still believe that Sonia continues to be the power behind the Manmohan throne; 57 per cent voters think the UPA has not delivered on the promises made in the Common Minimum Programme; 43 per cent of the voters feel the BJP stands to benefit considerably if Gujarat Chief Minister Narendra Modi is projected as its prime ministerial candidate in the next elections.

The poll also shows that Manmohan was tinkering with the truth when he told former US president George W. Bush in Washington last year that Indians love the United States. Asked if India should have closer relations with the US, an overwhelming 64 per cent said no. Yet, it is an undeniable fact that the longest queues for visas are seen outside the US Embassy in New Delhi and its consulates in the metros which perhaps goes to prove that people don't always vote the way they say they will.